4.2.1 When is a preflight request sent?

Even with the same-origin policy in place, there are ways to make some types of cross-origin requests from the browser. Appendix D goes into more details about these techniques, but here are two ways the client can circumvent the same-origin policy:

- *A web page can easily make GET requests to another origin.* Every `<script>` tag or `<img>` tag issues a `GET` request.
- *A web page can make POST requests via the <form> tag.* The `<form>` tag also allows the Content-Type header to be set to `application/x-www-form-urlencoded`, `multipart/form-data`, or `text/plain`.

The following listing shows the code that can be used to make these cross-origin requests. (You don't need to download or run this listing, it's only meant as an example.)

Listing 4.3 Making cross-origin requests without CORS

```
<html><body>

<img src="http://example.com/image.jpg">

<form enctype="text/plain" method="post" action="http://example.com/
     form_submit" id="myform">
  <input type="submit" value="Submit" />
</form>

<script>

var img = document.createElement('img');
img.src = 'http://example.com/image.jpg';

var myform = document.getElementById('myform');
myform.submit();

</script>
</body></html>
```

Using HTML to make GET request for an image

Using HTML to make POST request with a Content-Type header

Using JavaScript to make GET request for an image

Using JavaScript to make POST request with a Content-Type header

These techniques existed long before the concept of CORS and preflights. Because the browser can make these requests without CORS, the preflight doesn't provide any additional value. For example, if there were a preflight on a `GET` request, the client could always use a `script` tag to get around the preflight. The browser skips the preflight in cases where the client can already make the cross-origin request through other means.

This gives a general overview of when a preflight is used. To state it more concretely, a preflight request is issued when a request meets any of the following criteria:

- It uses an HTTP method other than `GET`, `POST`, or `HEAD`
- It sets the Content-Type request header with values other than
  a `application/x-www-form-urlencoded`
  b `multipart/form-data`
  c `text/plain`